



MCP Doesn't Have a Context Problem



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Everything Has a Context Problem



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Hot Takes

“MCPs ... are a constant cost and garbage in my context. Use GitHub’s MCP and see 23k tokens gone.”

– PETER STEINBERGER · STEIPETE.ME · 14 OCT 2025

“All of those tool descriptions take up a lot of valuable real estate in the agent context even before you start using them.”

– SIMON WILLISON · SIMONWILLISON.NET · 4 NOV 2025

“This static and exhaustive approach quickly exhausts an agent’s context window, especially for large platforms with thousands of endpoints.”

– SHARON GOLDBERG, MATT CAREY & IVAN ANGUIANO · CLOUDFLARE · 14 APR 2026

“A big gripe people have with MCP is the always-on context hit. For Sentry in a basic form, this is ~14,000 tokens.”

– DAVID CRAMER · CRA.MR · 29 OCT 2025

“Some MCP servers include many tools, often with long descriptions, which can significantly bloat the context window.”

– CURSOR ENGINEERING · 6 JAN 2026

“With thousands of tools, agents may process hundreds of thousands of tokens before reading a request.”

– ADAM JONES & CONOR KELLY · ANTHROPIC · 4 NOV 2025



Hot Takes

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– PETER STEINBERGER · STEIPETER

“All of those tool descriptions are valuable real estate in your context window before you start using them.”

– SIMON WILLISON · SIMONWILLISON

“This static and exhaustive list of endpoints exhausts an agent’s context window in thousands of endpoints.”

– SHARON GOLDBERG, MATT CARROLL



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tools, often with significantly bloat the

agents may consume hundreds of thousands of tokens

PIC · 4 NOV 2025



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“All of those tool descriptions are valuable real estate in your context before you start using them.”

– SIMON WILLISON · SIMONWILLISON

“This static and exhaustive list of agent’s context window sizes is thousands of endpoints away from the truth.”

– SHARON GOLDBERG, MATT CARROLL



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PIC · 4 NOV 2025



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PIC · 4 NOV 2025



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– SHARON GOLDBERG, MATT CARL



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sands of tokens

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Context Windows Classic MCP



Context:

Classic MCP Context
Window



Context Windows Tool Search



Context:

Deferred MCP Tool
Context Window



Context Windows Agent Skills



Context:

Agent Skills Context
Window



Context Windows

Just use CLIs



Context:

Bash only context
window





mcpi v0.85.2

escape interrupt · ctrl+c/ctrl+d clear/exit · / commands · ! bash · ctrl+o more
Press ctrl+o to show full startup help and loaded resources.

mcpi can explain its own features and look up its docs. Ask it how to use or extend mcpi.

[Extensions]

@sammorrowdrums/mcpi-ext@1.1.3:dist

[code-mode] 86 tool(s) across 1 server(s), 21 namespace(s); 54 unattended, 32 approval-gated; output
schemas: 31 declared, 55 synthesized, 0 unavailable



~

\$0.000 (sub) 0.0%/1.0M (auto)

claude-opus-5 • medium

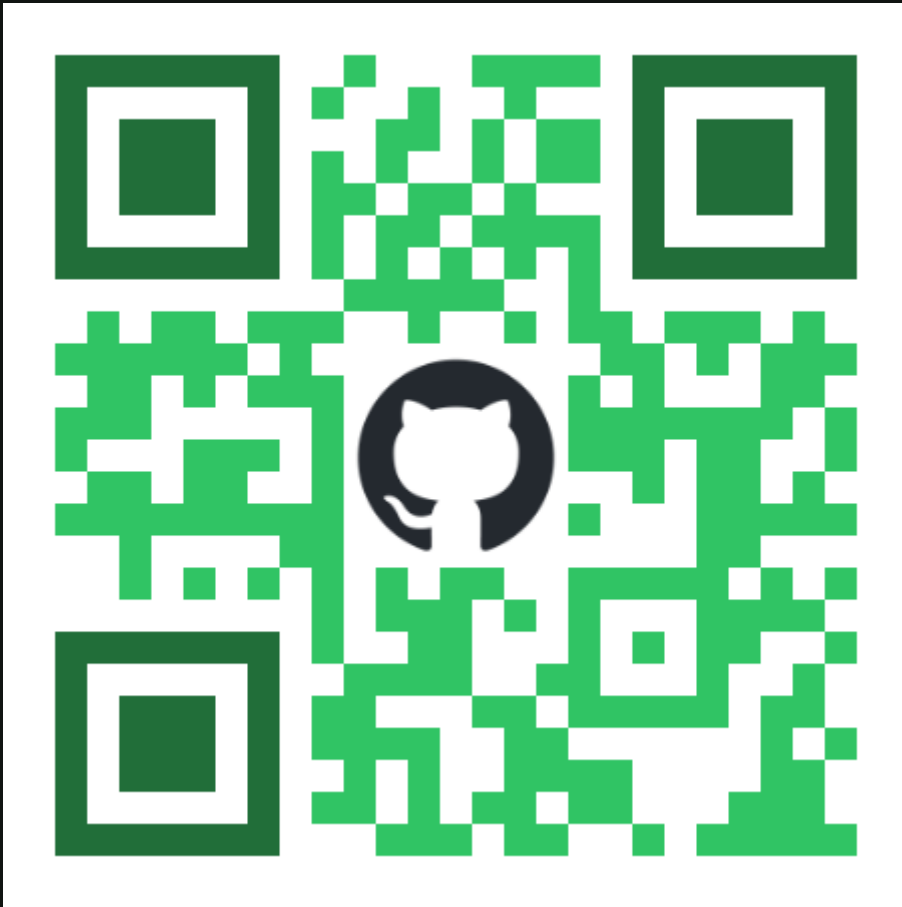


- Progressive discovery is everywhere
- All tool calls go through one chokepoint
- Skills can load tools



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gh.io/mcpi



gh.io/sams-blog



Wrapping Up





Thank you